

MATTHEW CHRESTENSON

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Professional Summary

AI-augmented strategist and business builder with 30+ years transforming ideas into market-leading brands across **health technology**, **hospitality**, and **consumer products**. Track record of six hospitality ventures built from concept to profitable exit. Currently architecting a **\$180M–\$450M patent portfolio** for a **MedTech** platform while building **full-stack SaaS** products. Unique combination of studio-grade production experience (**Disney**, **National Geographic**, **Ridley Scott Associates**), hands-on operational leadership, and technical development capability. Not just **AI-literate**—**AI-native**.

Key Achievements

- **6 Ventures → Exit** — Hospitality concepts built from scratch through profitable sale
- **\$180M–\$450M IP Portfolio** — Architected 19-patent strategy with full FTO compliance
- **Full-Stack Technical** — Built production SaaS platforms (React, TypeScript, PostgreSQL)
- **Institutional-Grade Analysis** — Strategic intelligence briefs on \$1B+ public companies
- **Studio Production** — Disney, National Geographic, Ridley Scott Associates

Professional Experience

SEALA

CSO Consultant | 2025–Present

- Built website, SEO infrastructure, and AI search optimization from scratch
- Developed proprietary estimate/costing software to accelerate sales cycle
- Launched Meta + Google ad strategy driving qualified lead pipeline

PRIME Reaction - REAXING S.p.A.

Chief Strategy Officer | 2023–Present

- Architected 19-patent IP portfolio valued at \$180M–\$450M with full FTO compliance across three competitor patent families
- Developed institutional-grade investment memoranda, financial models, and 24-month capital deployment projections

- Designed IP-first business model transformation, repositioning company from hardware distributor (1–2x multiple) to MedTech licensing platform (8–15x multiple)
- Built regulatory roadmap including FDA 510(k) pathway planning and clinical validation protocols
- Created multi-segment pricing architecture (\$15K–\$80K ranges) with recurring revenue conversion strategy

Chrestenson Construction

Business Consultant | 2022–Present

- Developed business structure and operational strategies for luxury remodeling services
- Implemented ADA compliance and universal design principles across residential projects
- Built subcontractor operational model with systematic project management

Prime Valley Ranch

Brand & Growth Lead | 2021–2025

- Positioning Central Coast oak as the gold standard for Santa Maria live-fire cooking
- Developed brand story, product line, and e-commerce rollout strategy
- Created educational content ecosystem converting buyers into brand evangelists

Citizen Ammunition

Business Strategy and Marketing | 2017–2020

- Scaled startup to \$4M+ annual U.S. revenue; developed international manufacturing workflow and domestic distribution logistics
- Built social media presence to 100K+ followers, driving brand awareness and direct sales pipeline
- Designed complete brand identity including packaging (consumer + shipping), trade show collateral, and retail displays

Union Ale Holdings

Owner / Operator / Chef | Santa Barbara, CA | 2008–2017

- Founded six distinct hospitality concepts that anchored downtown Santa Barbara's craft-beer boom
- Sparked the Funk Zone's transformation into a regional cultural destination
- Built scalable operations playbook—multi-unit margins up, guest satisfaction at record highs
- Achieved nearly a decade of double-digit growth before profitable exit

City Kitchen / Cities BBQ / City Catering

Owner / Operator / Chef | Santa Barbara, CA | 1999–2006

- Built three complementary F&B formats with farm-fresh sourcing into citywide cult following
- Led menu R&D, team culture development, and full P&L management
- Sold all three ventures profitably

Freelance Motion Graphics & Web Design

Designer | Los Angeles, CA | 1995–2001

- Designed official web launches for Pearl Harbor and Unbreakable (Disney)
- Delivered digital and video campaigns for Ridley Scott Associates, National Geographic, Disney Multimedia

Restaurant Chef Roles

Head Chef / Sous Chef | Santa Barbara, CA | 1988–1994

- Fast-tracked to Head Chef at age 20 (Mischa)
- Trained under Pete Clemens and Nancy Weiss

Technical Skills

Full-stack development (React 18, TypeScript, Vite, GSAP, Node.js, Express, PostgreSQL, Supabase, Redis, Tailwind CSS) · **AI-native workflows** (Claude Code, ChatGPT, Gemini, MidJourney, Runway ML, VEO 3) · **Web platforms** (Replit, Framer, Figma, Webflow, WordPress) · **Production design** (Adobe Creative Cloud, DaVinci Resolve) · **Business systems** (HubSpot, Pipedrive, JobNimbus, Notion, Google Analytics 4, Microsoft Clarity) · **Healthcare/regulatory** (FDA 510(k), De Novo, SaMD, HL7 FHIR R4, HIPAA, CMS billing, AKS compliance) · **IP systems** (USPTO, EPO, WIPO, CNIPA, FTO analysis)

Core Competencies

Build it (full-stack dev, product architecture) • **Model it** (financial projections, unit economics) • **Protect it** (patent strategy, FTO compliance) • **Position it** (brand development, category creation) • **Sell it** (B2B enterprise, \$50K+ deal cycles) • **Scale it** (multi-unit ops, franchise systems) • **Exit it** (6 ventures sold profitably)

References and portfolio available at chrestenson.com